

Power & Money,” set out to examine today’s successful woman and concluded that women had become the de facto CEO of most American households. The fourth wave of the study, released in January 2012, titled “Game Changers: Women Defining the New American Marketplace,” found that a woman’s preferences have amplified and become the de facto defining preferences for today’s marketplace. The emergence of social media, which “expands one’s sphere of influence, and has shaped the attitude that one can and should express opinions,” has been instrumental in increasing a woman’s influence in the marketplace. For instance, women are more likely than men to be a friend or fan of a product or company on Facebook. The article concluded that the proliferation of information in the marketplace, the economic downturn, and the emergence of social media has made the market ripe for coupons and discounts and fostered a fundamental shift in marketplace power.

There is no denying that technology plays a huge role in the lives of today’s women, especially mothers. My *Women’s Circle* magazine with the recipes and pen pal ads has been replaced by the social media of Facebook, Twitter, and blogs. BSM Media’s research indicates that two in three (65%) of today’s moms use at least five separate technologies, including wireless devices, videos, and blogs, just to get through their days. According to Quantcast, 42 million American women take part weekly in social media, and 76 percent of women between the ages of eighteen and twenty-six regularly engage in social media.

The Nielsen Company, which tracks consumer trends and behavior around the world, reports that 87 million American women between the